

Case Study Note-Taking Guide

Business English Weekend Intensive — For Use With Any Case Study



CASE STUDY NOTE-TAKING GUIDE

How to Take Quality Notes on a Case Study

Worth 15% of your final grade — scored on accuracy, not neatness or length.

Your physical notebook is your primary tool during the Open-Book OMR Test and the Socratic Live Debate — you are allowed to use it in both. Strong notes will directly determine how well you perform in those two components, so treat this as a serious research tool, not a formality.

PART 1: REQUIRED SECTIONS IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

Organize your physical notebook into four labeled sections, in this order. Use a new page for each.

Section A — Business Vocabulary Glossary

As you encounter each bolded/key business term in the case study (the case's glossary section lists them, but terms also appear throughout the document), write: - The term - Its definition **in your own words** (not copied directly from the glossary) - One example of how it applies specifically to the organization in the case

Model format: “[**Term**] — [your definition, in your own words]. In this case: [how the term applies to the organization] (Section __).”

Section B — Claim / Evidence / Question Annotations

While reading the case study, use a three-column or three-symbol system for each section you read: - **C (Claim):** A statement a stakeholder or the narrator makes - **E (Evidence):** The specific data, quote, or fact that supports (or fails to support) that claim - **Q (Question):** Something you're unsure about or want to challenge

Model format: “C: [What a stakeholder or the narrator claims] (Section __). E: [The data, quote, or fact that supports or undercuts it] (Section __). Q: [What is still unclear, or what you would challenge]”

Section C — Your Assigned Question Research Log

Dedicate several pages to your specific assigned research question (from the case's question bank). Log: - Your problem statement (in your own words) - Every piece of evidence you plan to use, with section number - Your draft recommendation, revised as your thinking develops - At least one counterargument to your own recommendation, and your response to it

Section D — Debate Prep Outline

Before the Socratic Live Debate, prepare: - Your opening argument (written in full, 3–5 sentences) - Two pieces of evidence you will cite - Anticipated pushback from a classmate, and how you'll respond - One question you could ask another student to challenge their position

PART 2: ACCURACY SCORING KEY (FOR TEACHER USE)

Physical notes are scored against this key — not for volume, handwriting, or decoration.

Component	Points	What “Accurate” Means
Vocabulary Glossary	30	Definitions are substantively correct (not necessarily word-for-word) and each includes an example specific to the case
Claim/Evidence/Question Annotations	30	At least 8 annotations across the case study; evidence cited actually supports (or accurately challenges) the claim identified; section numbers are correct
Research Log	25	Evidence entries cite correct section numbers and accurately represent what that section says; recommendation is present and has evolved/been revised, not just written once
Debate Prep Outline	15	Opening argument is complete and specific; at least one real counterargument is anticipated (not a strawman)

Total: ___ / 100 (scaled to the 15% overall weight)

PART 3: COMMON MISTAKES THAT LOWER ACCURACY SCORES

- Copying the glossary definitions from the case's glossary section word-for-word instead of paraphrasing (CCSS L.9-10.6/L.11-12.6 requires *using* vocabulary accurately, which means demonstrating understanding, not transcription).
 - Citing a section number that doesn't actually contain the fact claimed — always double check the reference before writing it down.
 - Writing a recommendation once at the start and never revising it, even after finding evidence that complicates it — strong notes show your thinking developing.
 - Skipping the counterargument in Section C — a recommendation with no acknowledged weakness is usually a sign of shallow analysis, not a strong argument.
-

Bring this notebook to every session. It is your single most valuable resource for the Open-Book OMR Test and the Socratic Live Debate — both allow notes, but only if the notes are actually useful.